

The landlord told me his house was full, and I agreed, rather than wander further on so bitter a night, to share a harpooneer's blanket if he were not decidedly objectionable.

My misgivings grew; I changed my mind about that harpooneer and tried the bench for a bed, till the knots, planes, and freezing draughts beat me off the plan.



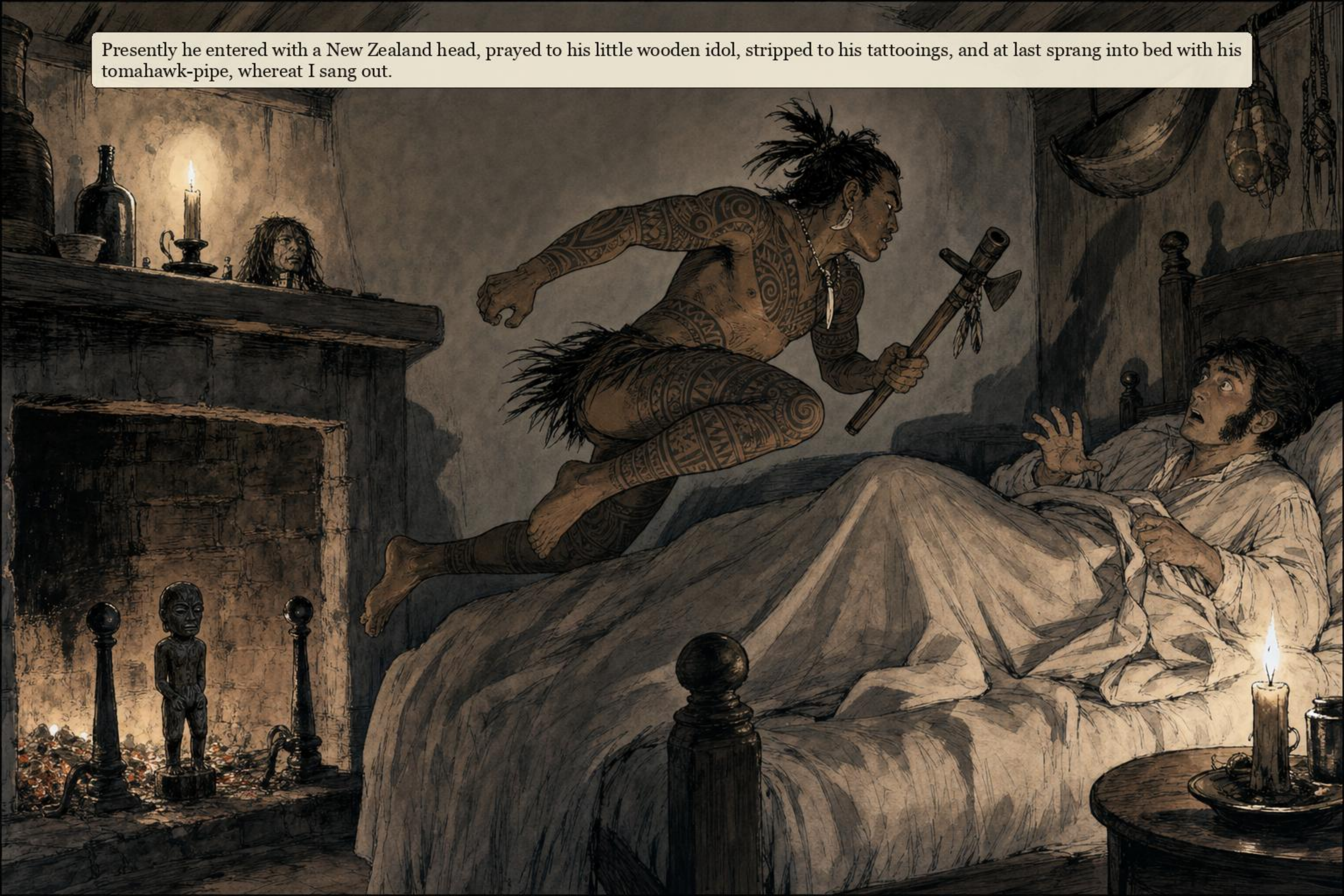


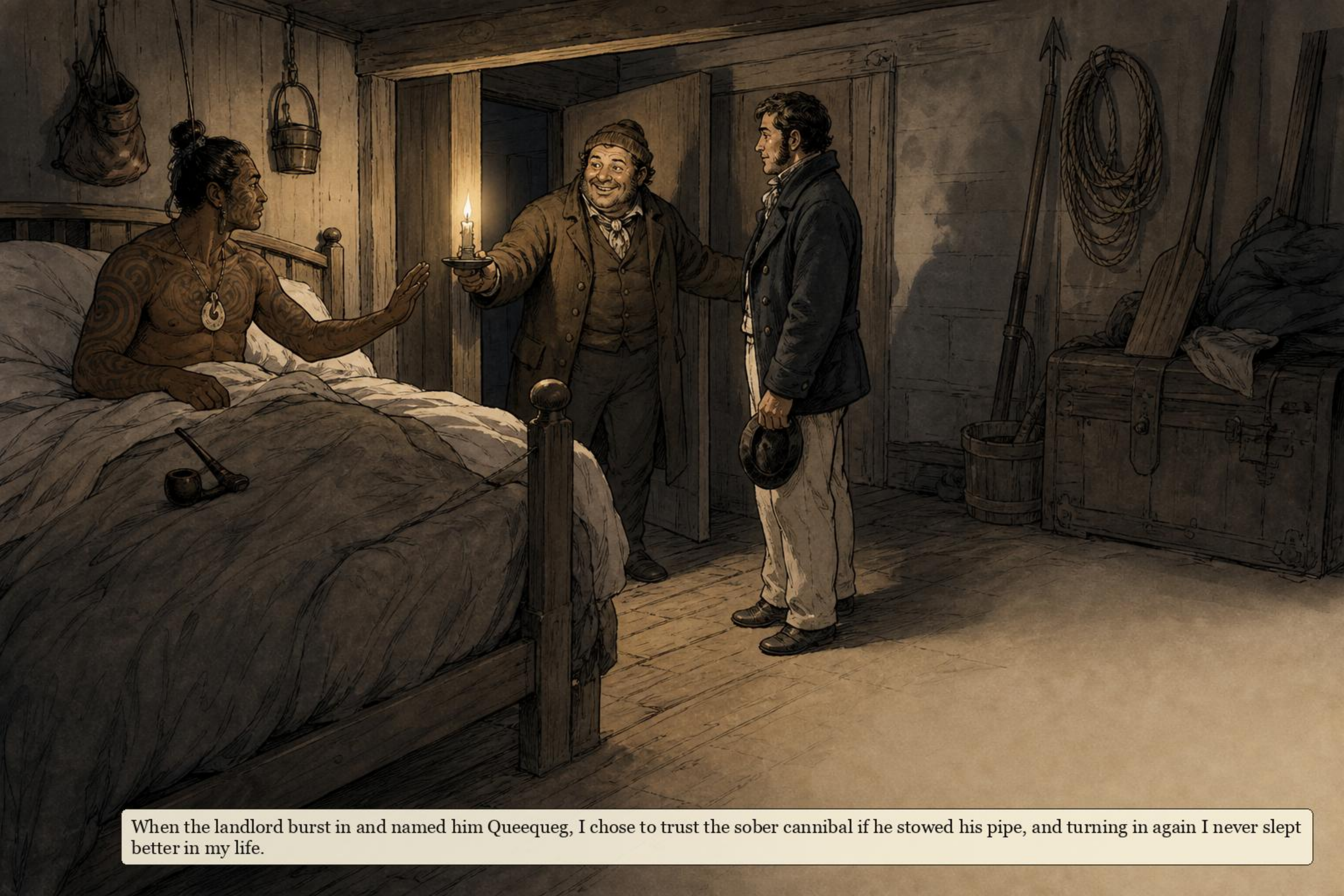
Close upon midnight I made the landlord speak out, learned the talk of 'selling his head' meant 'balmed New Zealand heads, and yet let him lead me up to the prodigious bed.

Alone, I examined the harpooneer's outlandish gear, even tried on his shaggy door-mat poncho, then, thinking he would not come, blew out the light and turned in.



Presently he entered with a New Zealand head, prayed to his little wooden idol, stripped to his tattooings, and at last sprang into bed with his tomahawk-pipe, whereat I sang out.





When the landlord burst in and named him Queequeg, I chose to trust the sober cannibal if he stowed his pipe, and turning in again I never slept better in my life.



Upon waking about daylight, I found Queequeg's tattooed arm thrown over me, blending with the patchwork counterpane until its weight told me I was hugged.

I tried to unlock his bridegroom clasp and wriggle free, when a slight scratch and a fling of the quilt showed the tomahawk sleeping by his side.

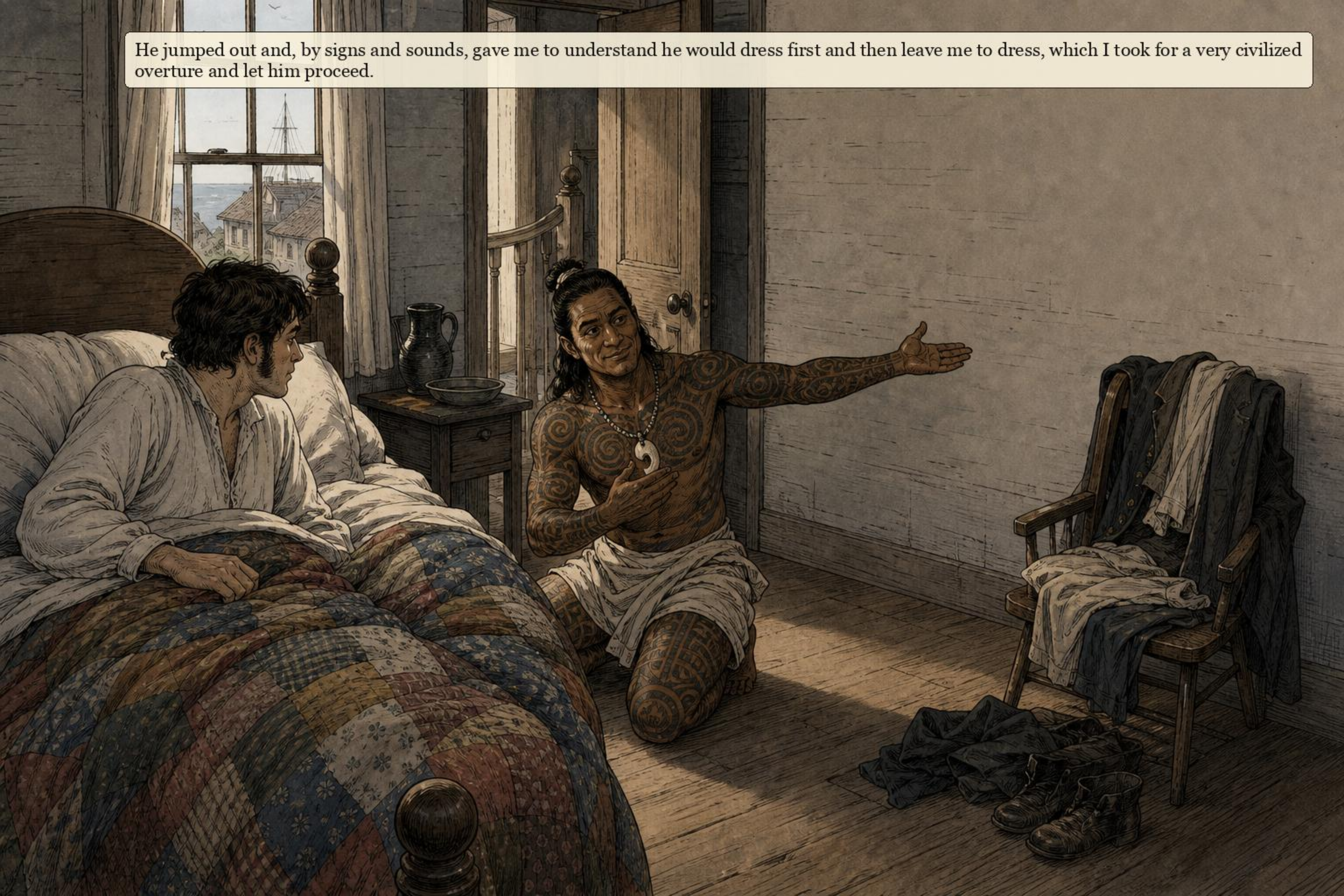


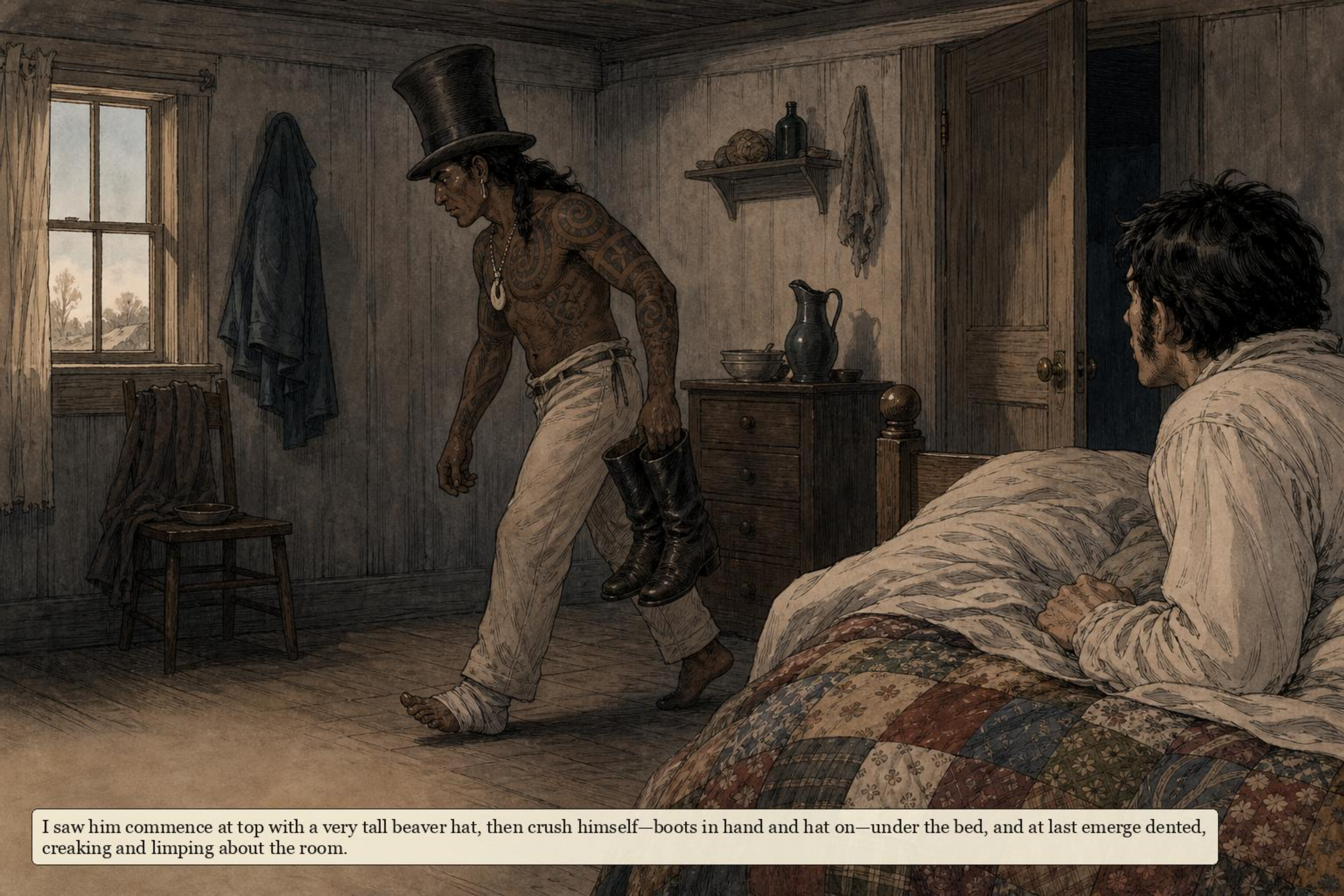


By dint of much wriggling and expostulation I roused him

; he shook himself like a Newfoundland dog and sat up, while I lay quietly eyeing him with no serious misgivings, bent on narrowly observing so curious a creature.

He jumped out and, by signs and sounds, gave me to understand he would dress first and then leave me to dress, which I took for a very civilized overture and let him proceed.





I saw him commence at top with a very tall beaver hat, then crush himself—boots in hand and hat on—under the bed, and at last emerge dented, creaking and limping about the room.

Seeing the window bare and his indecorous figure, I begged him to accelerate his toilet and get into his pantaloons, which he did.



To my amazement he washed only chest, arms, and hands, then lathered his face and, unsheathing the harpoon head, fell to harpooning his cheeks before marching out wrapped in his pilot monkey jacket, sporting the weapon like a marshal’s baton.